THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 12: **Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** is unobserved by the owner	The owner is in the village and will not see him.
2	**(b)** mystery and a hint of danger	Dark and deep are both inviting and fearful.
3	**(d)** description to decision	Scene first, then choice.
4	**(b)** a reason why the stop is safe	It connects the owner's absence with the speaker's freedom.
5	**(b)** a triad of adjectives	Three descriptive words in a row.
6	**(b)** he pauses briefly but chooses his duty	He leaves to keep promises.
7	**(c)** the unrhymed line of one stanza leads the rhyme of the next	A chain rhyme runs across stanzas.
8	**(b)** alliteration	Repeated initial d.
9	**(a)** pleasure of the woods and duty ahead	The woods against promises.
10	**(a)** AABA BBCB CCDC DDDD	Each stanza's third line leads the next stanza's rhyme.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The owner is in the village and cannot see the speaker (1). The speaker can enjoy the snow undisturbed (1).	1+1
12	He praises the woods as lovely (1). The word 'But' turns him back to his promises (1).	1+1
13	Frozen suggests cold and hardness (1). Downy suggests softness and comfort (1).	1+1
14	It gives voice to practical sense (1). It shows the stop is unusual and makes the speaker reflect (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He is the only companion (1). His bells and puzzlement bring the speaker back to reality (1). He is a personified voice of ordinary routine (1).	1+1+1
16	The sentence runs from line to line in stanza one (1). It makes the reading smooth like drifting snow (1). It keeps the tone quiet and natural (1).	1+1+1
17	All lines rhyme alike (1). The sameness suggests sleep and fatigue (1). The effect is a lulling close (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Snow softens sound and sight (1). The isolated woods and frozen lake give quiet (1). The darkest evening adds a hush (1).	1+1+1
18	A real traveller stops in real woods (1). Promises, miles and sleep widen the meaning (1). The simple scene becomes a picture of life (1).	1+1+1
	OR: 'sleep' (1). The line is repeated, so the device is repetition or refrain (1). It stresses the poet's duty (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Stanzas one to three describe the scene (1). The start of stanza four shows the woods' pull (1). The 'But' turns to duty (1). The last lines give the final emphasis (1). Nature serves as a contrast for duty (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Alliteration and soft sounds mirror falling snow (1). Slow, even rhythm matches the horse's pace (1). Chained rhymes carry the poem forward (1). Repetition mimics sleepiness (1). Sound therefore supports the mood (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme: beauty versus duty (1). Imagery: snow, woods, bells (1). Rhyme: chained scheme ending in a full rhyme (1). Tone: quiet, reflective, resolute (1). Overall: a simple scene with deep meaning (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Explain the poem's moment (1). Show why duty matters (1). Mention that rest and beauty also matter (1). Closing appeal (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 12: **Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** alliteration	Repeated w.
2	**(a)** boisterous	Boisterous is loud; the scene is quiet.
3	**(d)** a sense of finality	A closed rhyme makes the ending firm.
4	**(b)** enjambment	The first stanza runs lines on in this way.
5	**(a)** isolation	No people or houses near.
6	**(d)** represents practical routine against dreaminess	He questions the pause.
7	**(d)** enjambment	The sense flows from one line to the next.
8	**(c)** whether the stop is an error	The stop seems a mistake.
9	**(a)** My little horse must think it queer	The horse is made to 'think'.
10	**(b)** quiet determination mixed with longing	He yearns but moves on.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The first is a statement of fact (1). The second carries added meaning of life's journey and tiredness (1).	1+1
12	Taking a moment to admire beauty refreshes us (1). But we must return to our responsibilities (1).	1+1
13	It stresses the silence of the place (1). The few sounds make the stillness more vivid (1).	1+1
14	Bells and wind break a deep quiet (1). They make the silence of the woods felt more strongly (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Alliteration in 'whose woods' and 'dark and deep' (1). Steady rhythm and chained rhymes (1). Repetition in the final line (1).	1+1+1
16	The shake of the harness bells (1). The sweep of easy wind (1). Both make silence seem deeper by contrast (1).	1+1+1
17	Lovely: beautiful and attractive (1). Dark: mysterious and quiet (1). Deep: vast, perhaps unfathomable (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Literally, rest at the end of a journey (1). Symbolically, it may hint at death (1). The repeated line leaves both meanings open (1).	1+1+1
18	'Woods fill up with snow' shows slow, silent change (1). 'Downy flake' shows softness (1). Both create gentle visual and touch images (1).	1+1+1
	OR: I think I know whose woods these are (1). The poem inverts word order for rhythm and rhyme (1). The meaning stays the same (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Literal: a long ride home before sleep (1). Symbolic: life's responsibilities (1). Possible hint at death as final rest (1). Repetition adds weight (1). The ending leaves the reader thinking (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format and greeting (1). Name the poem and poet (1). Describe what you liked about the images (1). Comment on the last lines (1). Closing and signature (1).	2+2+1
20	Plain language and everyday setting (1). A pause in a journey as the central moment (1). Symbols give wider meaning (1). The speaker's decision shows the idea (1). The reader links it to own life (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening in the horse's voice (1). Why the stop seemed queer (1). Why you shook your bells (1). Your feelings in the snow (1). Relief when the journey resumed (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 12: **Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** a lulling, almost sleepy rhythm	It echoes drowsiness.
2	**(b)** the ease belongs to the mood, not to the wind	The easy feeling is shifted to the wind.
3	**(d)** apply to every reader's duties	Open reference makes it universal.
4	**(c)** A Pause on a Winter Evening	It captures the pause.
5	**(b)** hearing	It describes the only sound.
6	**(d)** life's long journey of duties	Journey and sleep suggest life and death.
7	**(d)** The poem's last lines are the most moving	Evaluation is an opinion.
8	**(a)** stillness and cold	A frozen lake is silent and cold.
9	**(d)** a lure of rest and escape	Their depth invites a final rest.
10	**(c)** The speaker is in the woods on a snowy evening	It is stated in the text.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He puts duty before pleasure (1). He keeps promises even when tempted to stay (1).	1+1
12	They are mysterious and inviting (1). They suggest depth of feeling and perhaps a final rest (1).	1+1
13	The linked rhymes carry the reader forward (1). The final four-line rhyme brings a sense of closure (1).	1+1
14	The promises and miles are unnamed (1). Every reader can see own duties and journey in them (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Before it, the poet admires the woods (1). It marks a turn to duty (1). It begins the argument of the final stanza (1).	1+1+1
16	It is a private thought spoken aloud (1). The reader overhears and shares it (1). That makes the poem feel intimate (1).	1+1+1
17	The silence in the empty house felt queer (1). The farmer fixed the harness on the ox (1). Both words suit the poem's setting (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The first stanza sets the scene and the owner (1). The last stanza states the decision (1). The first is descriptive; the last is reflective and firm (1).	1+1+1
18	The woods tempt with peace (1). The speaker feels the pull but resists (1). Duty wins over pleasure (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Describe the situation (1). Say what you wanted and what you had to do (1). Link it to the poet's decision (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Woods: peace and temptation (1). Snow: stillness and softness (1). Horse: practical sense and duty (1). Their combined effect is a conflict (1). Readers may offer other readings (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Stanza one: the owner and the stop (1). Stanza two: the horse's puzzlement (1). Stanza three: bells, wind and snow (1). Stanza four: the woods' lure, the decision and the repetition (1). The last stanza resolves the rhymes and mood (1).	2+2+1
20	The speaker is dreamy and appreciative (1). The horse is practical and puzzled (1). The horse prompts action (1). The speaker eventually agrees (1). Together they show the tension between wish and duty (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Pausing to enjoy nature helps (1). Homework and promises must be kept (1). Balance rest and work (1). Learning has miles to go (1). Persistence is the message (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.